

Eleftheria-Paraskevi (Elia) Kazantzi

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EDUCATION

Imperial College London, London, UK

MSc in Applied Biosciences and Biotechnology

2020 – 2021

Grade: Merit

King's College London, London, UK

BSc in Biochemistry

2017 – 2020

Grade: Upper Second Class Honours

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

IBM, London, UK

Software Engineer

2022 – Present

- Designed and shipped Java microservices (Spring Boot) for HMRC's Customs Declaration Service (CDS) across 3 AWS Availability Zones on EC2 and supporting millions of UK customs transactions daily.
- Embedded with HMRC stakeholders, QA, DevOps and business analysts to deliver features across inventory, exports and compliance workflows, translating ambiguous regulatory requirements into production systems within a highly constrained, risk-sensitive environment.
- Contributed to a 15% improvement in system performance through multithreading and computational optimisations while applying BDD (Cucumber/Gherkin) and TDD (JUnit, JMeter) practices daily.
- Identified, built, and drove adoption of an internal AI assistant using IBM Consulting Advantage (ICA) to automate requirements writing and QA test generation; navigated stakeholder concerns in a highly risk-averse government environment to integrate it into delivery workflows.

PROJECTS & ACTIVITIES

NHS Clinical Trial Finder | Personal Project

2026 – Present

- Built a Claude-powered Python assistant matching patient profiles to UK clinical trials via the ISRCTN API, using tool-calling and structured outputs to return plain-English eligibility reasoning; designed prompt structure and output schemas with evaluation criteria and failure handling to ensure reliable responses across varied inputs.

Code the Future Nepal | IBM Giveback / Volunteering

2024

- Led daily coding workshops for 20 children in Nepal over 2 weeks, taking them from zero programming knowledge to building and publishing their own websites using HTML and CSS.

IBeeMonitor | IBM Hackathon | Award-Winning

2022

- Designed and delivered an end-to-end IoT/AI web application tracking pollinator diversity, integrating real-time sensor data with an AI identification layer and a React interface, winning the IBM internal hackathon for technical innovation and end-to-end delivery.

SKILLS

Programming & Frameworks: Python, Java, TypeScript, JavaScript, React, HTML, CSS, Spring Boot

Backend & Tools: REST/SOAP APIs, IBM MQ, Oracle SQL, Atomikos, Jenkins, Ansible, Maven, Git

Testing & Methodologies: BDD (Cucumber/Gherkin), TDD (JUnit), Agile

Certifications: IBM Trustworthy AI and AI Ethics, IBM Consulting – Communicating Value, IBM Consulting – Delivering Business Value, IBM Cloud Advocate Essentials, AWS Cloud Practitioner (*course completed*)

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Awards: IBM HMRC CDS Early Professional Superstar, IBM CIC Role Model Award, IBM Women Powering the Tech Industry (short-listed), IBM Engineering Practice the Glue Award – Teamwork & Collaboration

Languages: Greek (Native), English (Fluent), French (B2)

Interests: Long distance running, photography, watercolour painting